Appendix 2: ME317 Project Feedback & Marksheet

ME317 Project (2026): Feedback & Marksheet

Project: What happened during the COVID-19 pandemic? (25% of the course)

Student	Batiste Decat
Date	2026-07-29
Overall mark	91 / 100

Marks

Part A: Content & analysis (60)

Criterion	What it assesses	Mark
A1. Data set	$\geq$10 stocks across sectors; source, structure, and cleaning (splits/dividends, NAs, anomalies).	9 / 10
A2. Returns, extremes & (non-)normality	Price/return dynamics; largest moves tied to dated events; skew/kurtosis, QQ, formal test, interpreted; sector scatterplots.	15 / 16
A3. Portfolio risk & backtesting	VaR and ES at 95% & 99% by three methods (empirical, normal, heavy-tailed); out-of-sample backtest; model-risk discussion.	18 / 20
A4. Dependence & copulas	Several copulas fitted and compared; best chosen; tail dependence and why joint crashes matter.	13 / 14
Part A subtotal		**55 / 60**

Part B: Method, interpretation & presentation (40)

Criterion	What it assesses	Mark
B1. Quantitative rigour	Right methods, correctly applied; assumptions checked; uncertainty and limitations acknowledged.	11 / 12
B2. Description & explanation	Explains what was done and why, so the reasoning can be followed.	7 / 8
B3. Clarity, structure & communication	Clear writing; logical structure; labelled figures/tables; within 8 pages.	7 / 8
B4. Synthesis & economic insight	One coherent story answering "what happened", not four stapled exercises.	6 / 7
B5. Reproducibility & code	Seed set; code in appendix; runs end-to-end; clean.	5 / 5
Part B subtotal		**36 / 40**

Comments

An excellent, genuinely analytical report. The all-euro Eurozone basket is a thoughtful design choice, the normality work pairs joint and single-stock tests with a clever study of what happens

as returns are added up over longer horizons, and the risk section earns its model-risk lesson by testing out-of-sample through a different shock ("the numbers looked fine until the regime changed"); the copula is correctly chosen and checked against how often the stocks actually crashed together. It is held back only by a minor point: the Clayton-vs-Gumbel asymmetry is fitted but not fully explained. A thorough and insightful piece, with AI use disclosed in line with the brief.